



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

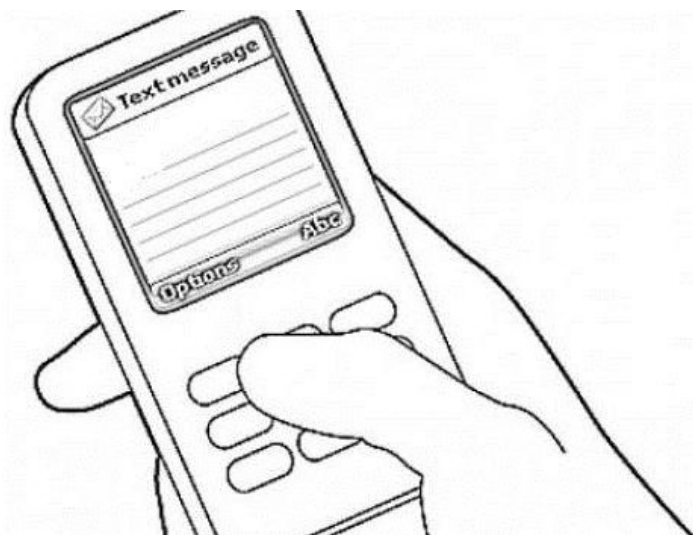
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### Let's Start!

Let's review!



### Learning Outcome

Use expressions about relationships and feelings in a range of social and work contexts.

### Can Do Statements

- I can ask for clarification.
- I can talk about people's past experiences.
- I can talk about future action.

### Ask your partner:

- Who do you talk to when you have personal problems? Why?
- Do you consider your very close friends as family members? Why or why not?





## Let's Explore!

Vanessa is lucky to have a **BFF\*** like Sally.

\* "BFF" is a short form of *Best Friends Forever*. It is very common in informal English and on the internet.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

- Sally:** Hey, V! Have you packed your bags yet? Can you tell me when you're leaving again?
- Vanessa:** Actually ... things didn't work out as I planned. We argued last night and I lost my temper. I've decided to break up with Marco. It's over.
- Sally:** I know what you mean, but are you sure about this?
- Vanessa:** Yes. I'm going to stick to this resolution. I want to make this getaway to Montreal work, but we've grown apart ever since he moved to Cambridge.
- Sally:** That's too bad. Don't you think that you were cute together?
- Vanessa:** I guess ... We used to have fun. He was my best boyfriend, hands down. Back when we were in San Francisco, we would really get along. I'm disappointed this hasn't worked out.
- Sally:** Do you know what you're going to do now?
- Vanessa:** I feel like I need to be on my own for a while. I'll probably take up yoga or Pilates with you.
- Sally:** That's a great idea. Physical activity will do you good. When do you think you'll be ready to meet someone?
- Vanessa:** I'm not sure. I'll play it by ear. I'm just glad to have you as my best friend.





## Let's Practice!

What does the future hold for Vanessa?

*Instructions: Read the sentences. Select all the sentences that talk about her future.*

- Actually ... things didn't work out as I planned.
- I feel like I need to be on my own for a while.
- I'm disappointed this hasn't worked out.
- I'm going to stick to this resolution.
- I'll probably take up yoga or Pilates with you.
- That's a great idea.
- Physical activity will do you good.
- I'll play it by ear.



## Let's Practice!

The relationship with Marco was different in San Francisco.

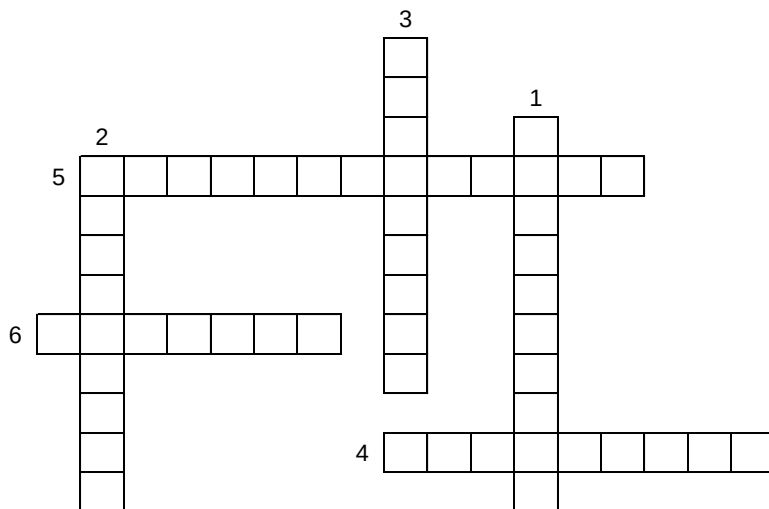
*Instructions: Read the definitions. Complete the crossword.*

### DOWN

- a decision you make and that you want to keep
- end a relationship
- continue doing something

### ACROSS

- by oneself
- improvise
- quick, usually improvised vacation





## Extension Activity

Talk about your best friend.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Think about the person you consider your best friend.
- On a piece of paper, write a few words and adjectives that describe your best friend.
- Talk about the stories you've had together in the past.
- Talk about the social activities you like to do right now.
- Talk about what you want to do in the future with your best friend.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about friendships and social activities.

☐ ☐

I tell stories and talk about past experiences.

☐ ☐

I talk about what I want to do in the future.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- resolution** (noun): a decision you make and that you want to keep  
e.g. I don't like to make New Year's resolutions.
- to stick to** (verb): to continue doing something  
e.g. I can never stick to my resolutions for more than two weeks.
- to break up** (verb): to end a relationship  
e.g. Why did you guys break up in the end?
- to grow apart** (verb): to become different from one another in a relationship  
e.g. We realized that we were growing apart.
- hands down** (expression): without question  
e.g. The Montreal nightlife beats Boston's hands down.
- getaway** (noun): a quick, usually improvised vacation  
e.g. Sounds like the perfect getaway with Marco.
- on your own** (expression): by yourself  
e.g. It's hard to live on your own in a big city.
- to take up** (verb): to become interested in an activity and spend time practicing it  
e.g. You don't have to be a world-class athlete to take up a new sport.
- to play it by ear** (expression): to improvise  
e.g.  
**Ann:** What will you do if you can't find anywhere to stay?  
**Bob:** We'll play it by ear.





## Learning Points

### Telling Stories and Anecdotes

When you talk about habits in the past, you can use **used to** and **would** to talk about recurring events or situations.

When you talk about events that occurred in the past, you can use the Present Perfect or Simple Past.

**Would** and **used to** have rather similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer.

However, there is an important difference between **used to** and **would**.

**Would** is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while **used to** does not require this.

Read the following example:

*We used to visit India. (correct)*

However, when **would** replaces **used to**, the same example becomes ungrammatical:

*We would visit India. (not correct)*

*We would visit India every summer when we were children. (correct)*

We use the **Present Perfect** tense for actions which started in the past and are still happening now OR for finished actions which have a connection to the present.

We use the **Simple Past** tense for past events or actions which have no connection to the present.

Look at the following chart for a distinction between the Present Perfect and Simple Past tenses:

| Rule                                                                      | Example                                   | Explanation              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| The <b>Present Perfect</b> is used when the time period has NOT finished. | <i>You've looked gorgeous ever since.</i> | You still look gorgeous. |
| The <b>Simple Past</b> is used when the time period HAS finished.         | <i>I had a rough week.</i>                | The week is over.        |



## Learning Points

### Talking About Future Actions

You can use two different tenses to talk about the future.

- When you talk about things that are not decided or when you make a decision at the moment of speaking for the future, you use the modal *will*.
- When you ask about intentions, you use *going to*.

| Structure       | Example                                                        |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Will</b>     | <i>Spending time together will be good for the two of you.</i> |
| <b>Going to</b> | <i>Do you know what you're going to do?</i>                    |

